

1946, August 14th

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

Saint Felix Friary
Huntington, Indiana.
Route 8

Mr. and Mrs. Joseph O'Donnell
1120 Lake Shore Drive
Chicago, Illinois

August 14th, 1946

Mr. and Mrs. J. J. O'Donnell - Joe. and Win. Chicago, Ill.

God bless you and keep you well - you and yours. I am glad to know you enjoyed your southern - S-Western trip and especially that you are returned safe and sound. Thanks be to God for all his wonderful, merciful designs.

Many thanks to you also for your kind favor just noted.

As to the Groves and the young trees; well we'll hope the enrollments and prayers otherwise may work something in their favor. We had quite an example here this past Spring and Summer. On the third of May (I believe that was the date), we had quite a heavy frost just when the apple-trees and grape-vines were nicely in bloom. We were rather anticipating what came; so that, in hopes the frost might be thwarted some way, one of the fathers went through the whole, plot or plots, with stole and ritual and holy-water blessing everything. Alas! Next morning, you can imagine our dismay. Notwithstanding the blessing the frost had come and seemingly frozen many of the apples and about 95% of the grapes.

It surely looked hopeless, especially in the vineyard. Father Guardian, now over 76 who had done so much pruning, etc. last Fall and during the Winter, felt worse, seemingly than anyone else. Only yesterday, in a talk he gave us, he acknowledged that he could have cried.

Nevertheless inside of ten days other shoots came out and blossomed and now the younger, to everyone's surprise, seem bigger and more promising than the first. Deo Gratias

August 15th.

The apple-trees and others, especially the pears and some of the peaches look very promising this morning, if only now the dear Lord sends us a good rain; for we have had it quite dry for the last six or seven weeks. We are praying that during the octave of our Bl. Mother's Assumption at least we may have the favor from Heaven of a good rain.